

6. A VOYAGE TO THE CITY OF LIONS

ABOUT THIS TOPIC

"A Voyage to the City of Lions" likely refers to a trip to Singapore, known as the "Lion City" due to its historical and cultural significance. The name "Singa Pura," meaning "Lion City," originates from a legend where a prince believed he saw a lion on the island. This voyage could be a journey to explore Singapore's attractions, history, and culture



EXERCISE 1- POST READING

Q:1: What is the geographical location of Singapore city?

Ans: The question has been taken from the chapter, 'A Voyage to the City of Lions', which is a travelogue, highlighting the geographical, economical and social importance of Singapore, globally. Singapore's name is itself derived from 'Singa Pura' (which means "Lion City"). According to the Malay Annals, Sang Nila Utama, a prince from Palembang, gave this name to the island after he came ashore and saw a creature he believed to be a lion. Located in Southeast Asia, Singapore consists of one 30-mile-long island (called Pulau Ujong, or mainland Singapore) surrounded by 62 smaller islands. The country's neighbors include Malaysia to the north and Indonesia to the south. It is one of the advanced countries of the world. The people who live there are rich and prosperous.

Q:2: What are barges and how are they operated?

Ans: The question has been taken from the chapter, 'A Voyage to the City of Lions', which is a travelogue, highlighting the geographical, economical and social importance of Singapore, globally. Barges don't have a motor or engine. They don't move independently. Instead, they move with the help of a towboat or a tugboat. They are flat-bottomed, and used on lakes, throughout canals, at seaports, and of course, across inland waterways.

Q:3: How is Singapore connected to Malaysia?

Ans: The two countries are connected by the Johor-Singapore Causeway and the Tuas Second Link. The Second Link is a bridge connecting Singapore and Johor, Malaysia. In Singapore, it is officially known as the Tuas Second Link.

Q4: Describe briefly the Singapore port?

Ans: The Port of Singapore is the busiest container trans-shipment hub and the largest publicly owned port in the world. Located on the southern end of the Malay Peninsula, 30km south-west of the Port of Johor in Malaysia, the Port of Singapore offers connectivity to more than 600 ports in 123 countries.

Q5: What are reasons for prosperity of Singapore in spite of very little area?

Ans: Singapore is known in the world as one of the prosperous and wealthiest countries in the area because Singapore's economy has been previously ranked as the most open in the world, the joint 4th-least corrupt, and the most pro-business. Singapore has low tax-rates and the second-highest per-capita GDP in the world in terms of purchasing power parity (PPP).

Q: 6: How is Singapore one of the attractive areas for tourists?

Ans: Located to the south of Malaysia, Singapore is known for its glitz and glamour. Often described as one of the cleanest and most orderly cities in the world, the island city-state

is also undoubtedly one of the world's most popular visitor destinations. From shopping frenzy, delectable culinary delights, awe-inspiring museums, adventurous theme parks, exotic gardens– Singapore has something for everyone.

Q:7: How does Singapore keep itself clean?

Ans: Singapore is recognized as 'Mr Clean' of the world. The spirit of cleanliness is present in everyone, from children to adults. The Keep Singapore Clean campaign was one of Singapore's first national campaigns as an independent nation. Launched on 1 October 1968 by then Prime Minister Lee Kuan Yew, the month-long campaign aimed to make Singapore the cleanest and greenest city in the region by addressing the problem of inconsiderate littering. Singapore is bent on maintaining its reputation of being impeccably clean, with an active campaign against littering and stringent enforcement in place. First time offenders who throw small items like cigarette butts or candy wrappers are fined \$300.

Q: 8: Describe any for interesting aspects of Singapore?

Ans: Aspects:

- 1:** Singapore's name is itself derived from 'Singa Pura' (which means "Lion City"). According to the Malay Annals, Sang Nila Utama, a prince from Palembang, gave this name to the island after he came ashore and saw a creature he believed to be a lion
- 2:** It's a city of (man-made) waterfalls.
- 3:** It's one of the world's greenest cities.
- 4:** It is fusion of East and West.

Q:9: Why is Singapore called the fusion of the East and the West?

Ans: Singapore is called the fusion of the East and the West because one finds modern buildings and lifestyles coexisting with the traditional way of life. Tourists stay in big hotels but eat meals in small restaurants to enjoy the cuisine the East and West. In terms of religion too, it is a multi cultural country. There exist Islam, Hinduism and Buddhism in Singapore. This very fusion of East and West is the main reason which has always attracted many Asian tourists towards Singapore.

Q:10: Describe briefly education in Singapore.

Ans: In Singapore, the system includes six years of primary school, followed by four to six years of secondary school, and one to three years of postsecondary school. The curriculum for primary schools is common for all students in years one to four. Government spends 25% of its income on education. Besides providing them quality education, students are encouraged to participate in debates, speeches and sports